

OTEL-07: Dynatrace OTLP Integration

Series: OTEL — OpenTelemetry Integration | **Notebook:** 7 of 8 | **Created:** January 2026 | **Last Updated:** 04/03/2026

Complete Setup for OpenTelemetry with Dynatrace

This notebook provides end-to-end configuration for sending OpenTelemetry data to Dynatrace, including authentication, endpoints, and verification.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Dynatrace Environment	SaaS or Managed with OTLP enabled

Requirement	Details
Permissions	Token creation access
Knowledge	OTEL-01 through OTEL-06

1. Dynatrace OTLP Endpoints

SaaS Endpoints

Dynatrace supports **OTLP/HTTP only** for native ingest. gRPC is not supported for direct ingest — use a Collector to convert gRPC to HTTP.

Signal	HTTP Endpoint
All (base)	<code>https://{env-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp</code>
Traces	<code>https://{env-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp/v1/traces</code>
Metrics	<code>https://{env-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp/v1/metrics</code>
Logs	<code>https://{env-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp/v1/logs</code>

Important: gRPC is **not supported** for direct Dynatrace ingest. If your SDKs use gRPC, route through a Collector with an `otlp` gRPC receiver and `otlphttp` exporter. See [Transform OTLP gRPC](#).

ActiveGate Endpoints

For on-premises or network-restricted environments:

Signal	Endpoint
All	<code>https://{activegate-host}:9999/e/{env-id}/api/v2/otlp</code>

Dynatrace Collector Distribution

Dynatrace provides its own **Collector distribution** with verified, production-ready components:

Aspect	Detail
Image	<code>ghcr.io/dynatrace/dynatrace-otel-collector/dynatrace-otel-collector</code>
Features	Pre-configured for Dynatrace, upstream-compatible, monthly releases
Docs	Dynatrace Collector

Tip: The Dynatrace Collector distribution is recommended for production deployments. It includes verified components and stays current with upstream releases.

Environment ID

Find your environment ID:

1. Log into Dynatrace
2. Look at the URL: `https://abc12345.live.dynatrace.com`
3. `abc12345` is your environment ID

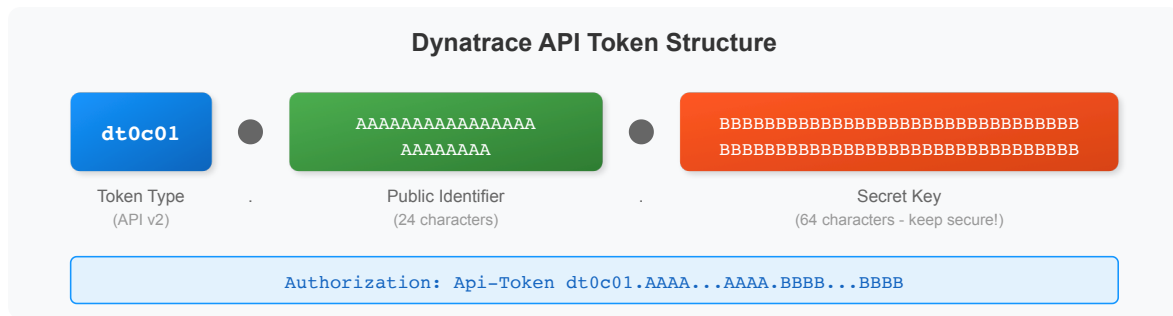
2. Authentication Setup

Create API Token

1. Navigate to **Settings > Access tokens**
2. Click **Generate new token**
3. Name: `otel-ingest-token`
4. Select scopes:

Scope	Signal	Required
<code>openTelemetryTrace.ingest</code>	Traces	Yes (for traces)
<code>metrics.ingest</code>	Metrics	Yes (for metrics)
<code>logs.ingest</code>	Logs	Yes (for logs)
<code>events.ingest</code>	Events	Optional

Token Format



Header Format

Use the `Api-Token` prefix in the Authorization header:

```
Authorization: Api-Token <your-full-token>
```

3. Collector Configuration

Image Versioning Best Practice

Important: Always pin your OTel Collector image to a specific version. Using `latest` can cause unexpected behavior during upgrades.

```
# Avoid – Non-deterministic deployments
image: otel/opentelemetry-collector-contrib:latest

# Recommended – Pin to a specific version
image: otel/opentelemetry-collector-contrib:0.120.0

# Or use the Dynatrace distribution
image: ghcr.io/dynatrace/dynatrace-otel-collector/dynatrace-otel-collector:latest
```

Check the [OpenTelemetry Collector releases](#) or [Dynatrace Collector releases](#) for the current stable version.

Complete Collector Config for Dynatrace

```
# otel-collector-config.yaml
receivers:
  otlp:
    protocols:
      grpc:
        endpoint: 0.0.0.0:4317
      http:
        endpoint: 0.0.0.0:4318

processors:
  batch:
    timeout: 10s
    send_batch_size: 1000

  memory_limiter:
    check_interval: 1s
    limit_mib: 800
    spike_limit_mib: 200

  # Add service.name if missing
  resource:
    attributes:
      - key: service.name
        value: "unknown-service"
        action: insert

exporters:
  otlphttp/dynatrace:
    endpoint: https://${DT_ENV_ID}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp
    headers:
      Authorization: Api-Token ${DT_API_TOKEN}
    retry_on_failure:
      enabled: true
      initial_interval: 5s
      max_interval: 30s
      max_elapsed_time: 300s

  debug:
    verbosity: detailed

extensions:
  health_check:
    endpoint: 0.0.0.0:13133

service:
```

```
extensions: [health_check]
pipelines:
  traces:
    receivers: [otlp]
    processors: [memory_limiter, resource, batch]
    exporters: [otlphttp/dynatrace]
  metrics:
    receivers: [otlp]
    processors: [memory_limiter, resource, batch]
    exporters: [otlphttp/dynatrace]
  logs:
    receivers: [otlp]
    processors: [memory_limiter, resource, batch]
    exporters: [otlphttp/dynatrace]
```

Resource Sizing Guide

Environment	CPU Limit	Memory Limit	Batch Size
Dev/Test	200m	256Mi	500
Staging	500m	512Mi	1000
Production	1000m	1Gi	2000

Running with Environment Variables

```
export DT_ENV_ID="abc12345"
export DT_API_TOKEN="&lt;your-api-token&gt;"

otelcol-contrib --config otel-collector-config.yaml
```

4. Direct SDK Export

Python Direct to Dynatrace

```
import os
from opentelemetry import trace
from opentelemetry.sdk.trace import TracerProvider
from opentelemetry.sdk.trace.export import BatchSpanProcessor
from opentelemetry.exporter.otlp.proto.http.trace_exporter import
OTLPSpanExporter
from opentelemetry.sdk.resources import Resource

# Configuration
DT_ENV_ID = os.environ["DT_ENV_ID"]
DT_API_TOKEN = os.environ["DT_API_TOKEN"]

# Resource with service name
resource = Resource.create({
    "service.name": "my-python-app",
    "service.version": "1.0.0",
    "deployment.environment.name": "production"
})

# Setup tracer
provider = TracerProvider(resource=resource)
exporter = OTLPSpanExporter(
    endpoint=f"https://{DT_ENV_ID}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp/v1/traces",
    headers={"Authorization": f"Api-Token {DT_API_TOKEN}"}
)
provider.add_span_processor(BatchSpanProcessor(exporter))
trace.set_tracer_provider(provider)
```

Java with System Properties

```
# Set environment variables first
export DT_ENV_ID="abc12345"
export DT_API_TOKEN="&lt;your-api-token&gt;"

# URL-encode the token for the header (space becomes %20)
java -javaagent:opentelemetry-javaagent.jar \
  -Dotel.service.name=my-java-app \
  -
Dotel.exporter.otlp.endpoint=https://${DT_ENV_ID}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp \
  -Dotel.exporter.otlp.headers="Authorization=Api-Token%20${DT_API_TOKEN}" \
  -jar app.jar
```

Node.js

```
const { NodeSDK } = require('@opentelemetry/sdk-node');
const { OTLPTraceExporter } = require('@opentelemetry/exporter-trace-otlp-http');
const { Resource } = require('@opentelemetry/resources');

const sdk = new NodeSDK({
  resource: new Resource({
    'service.name': 'my-node-app',
  }),
  traceExporter: new OTLPTraceExporter({
    url:
`https://${process.env.DT_ENV_ID}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp/v1/traces`,
    headers: {
      'Authorization': `Api-Token ${process.env.DT_API_TOKEN}`,
    },
  }),
});

sdk.start();
```


5. Entity Mapping

How Dynatrace Maps OTel Data

OTel Resource Attribute	Dynatrace Entity	Notes
<code>service.name</code>	Service	Required for service detection
<code>service.namespace</code>	Service group	Optional grouping
<code>host.name</code>	Host	Links to host entity
<code>k8s.namespace.name</code>	K8s namespace	Links to K8s entities
<code>k8s.pod.name</code>	Process group	Links to pod

Essential Resource Attributes

Always set these for proper entity mapping:

```
resource = Resource.create({
  # Required
  "service.name": "checkout-api",

  # Recommended
  "service.version": "1.2.3",
  "service.namespace": "ecommerce",
  "deployment.environment.name": "production",

  # For K8s
  "k8s.namespace.name": "checkout",
  "k8s.pod.name": "checkout-api-abc123",
  "k8s.deployment.name": "checkout-api",
})
```

6. Span Attributes for Dynatrace

Dynatrace-Specific Attributes

Attribute	Purpose	Example
<code>dt.entity.process_group_instance</code>	Link to PGI	<code>PROCESS_GROUP_INSTANCE-XXX</code>
<code>dt.span.type</code>	Override span type	<code>DATABASE , MESSAGING</code>
<code>dt.source</code>	Data source	<code>opentelemetry</code>

Semantic Conventions Dynatrace Uses

Convention	Dynatrace Feature
<code>http.*</code>	HTTP service detection
<code>db.*</code>	Database call analysis
<code>messaging.*</code>	Message queue tracking
<code>rpc.*</code>	RPC call tracking

Example with Rich Attributes

```
with tracer.start_as_current_span("checkout") as span:
    # Standard semantic conventions
    span.set_attribute("http.method", "POST")
    span.set_attribute("http.url", "https://api.example.com/checkout")
    span.set_attribute("http.status_code", 200)
    span.set_attribute("http.route", "/checkout")

    # Business context
    span.set_attribute("order.id", order_id)
    span.set_attribute("order.total", order_total)
```

7. OTLP Metric Dimensions

Advanced OTLP Metric Dimensions (January 2026)

Dynatrace introduced an opt-in setting for **advanced OTLP metric dimensions**:

Feature	Details
Primary Grail Fields	Metrics can carry Primary Grail Fields as dimensions
Higher Cardinality	Increased cardinality limits for metric dimensions
Faster Queries	Performance improvements for high-cardinality metrics
Special Characters	Dimension names can include slashes and other special characters

Warning: After enabling advanced OTLP metric dimensions, OTLP metrics will **no longer** be automatically enriched with the `dt.entity.service` dimension. If you use `dt.entity.service` in SLOs, alerts, or dashboards, update your queries to filter using the underlying attributes (e.g., `service.name`) instead.

Scope Attributes as Dimensions

When **Add Meter name and version as metric dimensions** is enabled:

- `otel.scope.name` (instrumentation library/scope name)
- `otel.scope.version` (instrumentation library/scope version)

These are automatically added as dimensions to ingested OTLP metrics.

OTLP Auto-Configuration for Kubernetes

Dynatrace Operator (v1.8+) supports **automatic OTLP exporter configuration** for K8s workloads:

Feature	Details
Auto-injection	Environment variables injected into application pods at startup

Feature	Details
Routing	Traffic routes through in-cluster ActiveGate if available
Control	Per-pod opt-in/out via <code>otlp-exporter-configuration.dynatrace.com/inject</code> annotation
Docs	OTLP Auto-Config

For more details, see [Configure OTLP Metrics Ingestion](#).

```
// Verify OTel traces are arriving
fetch spans, from:-1h
| filter isNotNull(otel.library.name)
| summarize count = count(), by:{service.name, otel.library.name}
| sort count desc
| limit 20
```

```
// Check recent OTel spans
fetch spans, from: now() - 1h
| filter isNotNull(otel.library.name)
| fields timestamp, service.name, span.name, duration
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 30
```

```
// View OTel data by instrumentation scope
fetch spans, from:-1h
| filter isNotNull(otel.scope.name)
| summarize count = count(), by:{otel.scope.name}
| sort count desc
| limit 10
```

8. Verification

Verify Data in Dynatrace

1. **Services:** Go to **Services** - OTel services appear with OTel icon
2. **Traces:** Go to **Distributed Traces** - Filter by service
3. **Metrics:** Go to **Metrics** - Search for custom metric names
4. **Logs:** Go to **Logs & Events** - Filter by `trace_id`

Troubleshooting Checklist

Check	How
Token scopes	Settings > Access tokens
Collector logs	<code>otelcol-contrib --config config.yaml</code>
Network connectivity	<code>curl -v https://{env}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/otlp</code>
service.name set	Check resource attributes

Common Issues

Issue	Cause	Fix
401 Unauthorized	Invalid token	Check token, regenerate
403 Forbidden	Missing scope	Add required scopes
No data	service.name missing	Add resource attribute
Partial data	Network timeout	Check batch size, retry config

9. Hybrid with OneAgent

Using OTel + OneAgent

Scenario	Recommendation
OneAgent-supported tech	Let OneAgent auto-instrument
Custom spans needed	Add OTel manual spans
Serverless	Use OTel (no agent)
Unsupported language	Use OTel SDK

Trace Context Propagation

OneAgent and OTel both support W3C Trace Context, enabling unified traces:

```
Service A (OneAgent) → Service B (OTel) → Service C (OneAgent)
```

↓ ↓

Dynatrace traces show complete path

Dynatrace traces show complete path

Configuration for Hybrid

Ensure both use W3C propagation:

```
# Python 0Tel
from opentelemetry.propagate import set_global_textmap
from opentelemetry.propagators.composite import CompositePropagator
from opentelemetry.propagators.w3c.traceparent import
W3CTraceparentPropagator
from opentelemetry.propagators.w3c.tracestate import W3CTracestatePropagator

set_global_textmap(CompositePropagator([
    W3CTraceparentPropagator(),
    W3CTracestatePropagator()
]))
```

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- Dynatrace OTLP endpoints (HTTP only — gRPC requires Collector)
- Dynatrace OTel Collector distribution for production deployments
- API token creation with required scopes
- Complete Collector configuration
- Direct SDK export configuration
- Entity mapping and resource attributes
- Span attributes that enhance Dynatrace analysis
- OTLP metric dimensions changes and auto-configuration
- Verification and troubleshooting
- Hybrid deployment with OneAgent

References

- [Dynatrace OpenTelemetry](#)
 - [OTLP API Endpoints](#)
 - [Dynatrace Collector](#)
 - [Configure OTLP Metrics](#)
 - [OTLP Auto-Config for K8s](#)
 - [Ensure Success with OTel](#)
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